David Lyons

Operations Leadership & Management | AI & Automation Builder

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SUMMARY

Operations leader and manager (14+ years) who also builds the systems — pairing people leadership with hands-on operations management, and both with self-taught data, automation, and AI. Drove a 54.5% jump in company-wide standings as a distribution-center GM by building a positive, high-performing team and coaching it to use its data tools daily; separately builds automations and AI agents that turn operational data into faster decisions and measurable results.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

General Manager **2024 – Present**

American Tire Distributors | Carrollton, TX

- Directed multi-million-dollar distribution center operations and spearheaded its turnaround, driving a 54.5% jump in company-wide standings through performance-driven initiatives, strategic planning, and refined data utilization.
- Built a positive, high-performing culture across a 30-person team by leading talent acquisition, mentoring operations staff, implementing training programs, and fostering data-driven decision-making.
- Improved warehouse efficiency by 10% by streamlining production workflows and coaching the team to use Excel effectively for shift planning and data analysis, reducing operational bottlenecks.
- Improved route truck delivery window success by 7.3% and enhanced customer satisfaction through driver training programs and manifest analysis while maintaining DOT compliance.
- Coached supervisors to monitor customer orders daily with OTIF (On-Time In Full) metrics and Power BI dashboards, enhancing visibility and enabling rapid disruption response.
- Improved financial performance by reducing overtime expenses 15% and improving inventory variance, mitigating missed product sales through strategic cost-saving measures.

Manager of Yard Operations **2022 – 2023**

Union Pacific Railroad | Mesquite, TX

- Ensured quality customer service, timely deliveries, system fluidity, and daily coordination of over 700 freight cars.
- Reduced safety incidents 3% by conducting Field Training Exercises, addressing rule violations, and enforcing Federal Code compliance.
- Reduced terminal dwell time by 2 hours by streamlining processes to improve efficiency and throughput in yard operations.
- Boosted departure reliability 5% through streamlined communication between yard operations and train dispatchers.

Corridor Manager **2016 – 2022**

Union Pacific Railroad | Spring, TX

- Led dispatching teams of 10+, monitoring terminal dwell and subdivision velocity, achieving a 5% increase in schedule adherence through a positive culture and strong field support.
- Supervised transportation plans across 3 corridors, coordinating with yard masters and field crews to prioritize main track access and increase throughput by upwards of 10%.
- Optimized operations across high-volume corridors, ensuring service quality for Class 1 railroads and reducing downtime 3 hours per week through revolving dispatcher shift plans.
- Prioritized safety and compliance through shift check-ins, reducing safety incidents 8% by reviewing active traffic, incidents, and dispatcher well-being.

Train Dispatcher **2011 – 2016**

Union Pacific Railroad | Omaha, NE

- Directed train traffic and coordinated train and maintenance crews across 2,000+ miles of territory, remotely managing signal systems and ensuring safe, efficient operations.
- Prevented a potential multi-million-dollar derailment by monitoring dispatch systems and intervening to halt an oncoming train when another went into emergency.
- Dispatched 15–35 trains daily of diverse types — Amtrak, coal, auto, and intermodal — carrying passengers and cargo.
- Elevated delivery timeliness by approximately 15% through strategic routing and scheduling adjustments, minimizing congestion across the rail network.

Land Surveyor / Survey Engineer **2009 – 2011**

Clear Fork Surveying & Mapping Co., Inc. | *Graham, TX*

- Performed all aspects of the entire field-to-finish land survey, including GPS data collection and total-station surveys to determine property boundaries, riparian boundaries, easements, and well-location surveys for as-drilled and permit plat requirements.
- Conducted project research to obtain legal descriptions from deeds and leases, then drafted legal descriptions and associated survey plats for deed records.
- Computed map projections between State Plane grid coordinates and geographic latitude/longitude.

SELECTED PROJECTS — AI & AUTOMATION

Kansas Castings — AI-Driven Growth Engine. Built an AI-driven SEO and cold-outbound system for a manufacturer; reached Google's AI Overview within a week of launch and generated real inbound revenue (WordPress REST, Python, JSON-LD, Apollo/Smartlead, email deliverability).

AITrader — Autonomous Trading Agents. Engineered multi-platform autonomous trading agents with an eval-first research harness and hard risk gates across five brokerages/markets (Python, broker APIs, walk-forward evaluation).

OpenClaw — Self-Hosted Agent Platform. Deployed a self-hosted, 7-agent orchestration platform with hybrid local/cloud model routing and cron automation on a hardened VPS (Node.js, systemd, MCP).

Agentic Dev Tooling. Built a custom AI development workflow (skills, rules, hooks + a Rust token-optimizer proxy) that cut routine development token cost 60–90%.

EDUCATION

Associate of Spatial Sciences — Texas A&M University

Certifications: Google Data Analytics (Coursera): Foundations: Data, Data, Everywhere · Ask Questions to Make Data-Driven Decisions · Prepare Data for Exploration · Process Data from Dirty to Clean · Analyze Data to Answer Questions

SKILLS

Leadership & Operations: Team Building & Hiring | Operations & Logistics Management | KPI & Performance Tracking | Cost Reduction & P&L | Safety & Compliance | Process Improvement

Data, AI & Automation: Power BI | Advanced Excel (Macros) | SQL | Python | AI Agents & LLM Tooling | Process Automation | Data Pipelines | API Integration | Technical SEO

Software: Oracle WMS | Descartes Logistics Suite | Power BI | Git/GitHub | Google Workspace | Generative AI Tools